Trade Promotions Guide and 2025-2026 Promotion Calendar

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Marvel CPG is a fictional company created for the University at Buffalo CDA 650 capstone. This document was written by Team 1 for the project's RAG knowledge base. Figures marked data *come from the project dataset; everything else is fictional business content.*

1 Purpose

This guide describes Marvel's consumer promotions: the promotion types, the 2025 and 2026 calendar, what promotions delivered in the data, and how a representative prepares a store for one. Promotions are planned by Marvel for a whole channel and category. During a promotion, **every account** in that channel sells the promoted category at the promoted price.

2 Promotion types and the sales lift each delivers

BOGO promotions give the biggest sales lift (+23% units), followed by Distributor Volume deals (+20%) and TPRs (+15%). Bundles add almost nothing (+2%).

(data) "Extra units" compares, for the same store and SKU in the same month, average daily units on promotion days with non-promotion days, using in-stock days only. The implied elasticity is the percentage change in units divided by the percentage change in price.

Type	What it is	Average discount	Extra units vs normal days (data)	Implied price elasticity (data)
BOGO	Buy One Get One: a multi-buy mechanic. In the calendar it is valued as a discount percentage.	15%	+23%	-1.29
Volume	Distributor volume deal: a discount for orders above a minimum quantity.	14%	+20%	-1.20
TPR	Temporary Price Reduction: a straight price cut for a fixed period.	10%	+15%	-1.27
Feature	The product is featured in the retailer's advertising (flyer, digital or in-store media) at a reduced price.	8%	+13%	-1.38
Display	The promoted product gets an off-shelf display (endcap, island) together with a price reduction.	9%	+11%	-1.18
Bundle	Products sold together as a bundle at a combined price, for example around the holidays.	12%	+2%	-0.18

Across all promotions, a store-SKU sold **12.9% more units at an average discount of 11%**, an elasticity of about **-1.0**: units rise by roughly the same percentage as the price falls. By channel *(data)*: Modern Trade +12.2% (elasticity -1.02), Traditional Trade +11.0% (-0.96), Distributors +19.9% (-1.20). By category: Surface Cleaners +12.6%, Dishwashing +11.7%, Laundry +15.2%.

Bundles are the exception: almost no extra units, so use them for visibility and basket-building, not for volume.

3 Promotion calendar

3.1 2025 calendar

Promotion	Type	Category	Channel	Dates	Discount	Minimum volume (units)
New Year Fresh Start (PRO-016)	TPR	Laundry	Modern Trade	05 Jan - 18 Jan 2025	10%	40

Promotion	Type	Category	Channel	Dates	Discount	Minimum volume (units)
Distributor Volume Deal Q1 (PRO-017)	Volume	Surface Cleaners	Distributor	20 Jan - 02 Mar 2025	14%	200
Distributor Volume Deal Q1 (PRO-018)	Volume	Dishwashing	Distributor	20 Jan - 02 Mar 2025	14%	200
Distributor Volume Deal Q1 (PRO-019)	Volume	Laundry	Distributor	20 Jan - 02 Mar 2025	14%	200
Spring Clean Blitz (PRO-001)	TPR	Surface Cleaners	Modern Trade	03 Mar - 23 Mar 2025	12%	50
Spring Clean Blitz (PRO-002)	TPR	Surface Cleaners	Traditional Trade	03 Mar - 23 Mar 2025	12%	50
Spring Clean Blitz (PRO-003)	TPR	Dishwashing	Modern Trade	03 Mar - 23 Mar 2025	10%	30
Spring Clean Blitz (PRO-004)	TPR	Dishwashing	Traditional Trade	03 Mar - 23 Mar 2025	10%	30
Traditional Trade Support (PRO-023)	Feature	Dishwashing	Traditional Trade	07 Apr - 27 Apr 2025	9%	20
Modern Trade Exclusive (PRO-025)	Display	Laundry	Modern Trade	12 May - 25 May 2025	7%	60
Summer Refresh (PRO-005)	Feature	Dishwashing	Modern Trade	02 Jun - 15 Jun 2025	8%	40
Summer Refresh (PRO-006)	Feature	Surface Cleaners	Modern Trade	02 Jun - 15 Jun 2025	8%	40
Distributor Volume Deal Q3 (PRO-020)	Volume	Surface Cleaners	Distributor	14 Jul - 24 Aug 2025	14%	200
Distributor Volume Deal Q3 (PRO-021)	Volume	Dishwashing	Distributor	14 Jul - 24 Aug 2025	14%	200
Distributor Volume Deal Q3 (PRO-022)	Volume	Laundry	Distributor	14 Jul - 24 Aug 2025	14%	200
Back to School (PRO-007)	Display	Laundry	Modern Trade	04 Aug - 24 Aug 2025	10%	60
Back to School (PRO-008)	Display	Laundry	Traditional Trade	04 Aug - 24 Aug 2025	10%	60
Back to School (PRO-009)	TPR	Surface Cleaners	Traditional Trade	04 Aug - 24 Aug 2025	8%	25
Fall Cleaning Event (PRO-010)	BOGO	Surface Cleaners	Modern Trade	15 Sep - 28 Sep 2025	15%	80
Fall Cleaning Event (PRO-011)	BOGO	Laundry	Modern Trade	15 Sep - 28 Sep 2025	15%	80
Traditional Trade Support (PRO-024)	TPR	Laundry	Traditional Trade	06 Oct - 26 Oct 2025	8%	20
Holiday Bundle (PRO-012)	Bundle	Dishwashing	Modern Trade	03 Nov - 30 Nov 2025	12%	50
Holiday Bundle (PRO-013)	Bundle	Dishwashing	Traditional Trade	03 Nov - 30 Nov 2025	12%	50
Holiday Bundle (PRO-014)	Bundle	Surface Cleaners	Modern Trade	03 Nov - 30 Nov 2025	12%	50
Holiday Bundle (PRO-015)	Bundle	Surface Cleaners	Traditional Trade	03 Nov - 30 Nov 2025	12%	50

3.2 2026 calendar (published to date)

Promotion	Type	Category	Channel	Dates	Discount	Minimum volume (units)
New Year Fresh Start (PRO-032)	TPR	Laundry	Modern Trade	05 Jan - 18 Jan 2026	10%	40
Distributor Volume Deal Q1 (PRO-033)	Volume	Surface Cleaners	Distributor	20 Jan - 02 Mar 2026	14%	200
Distributor Volume Deal Q1 (PRO-034)	Volume	Dishwashing	Distributor	20 Jan - 02 Mar 2026	14%	200
Distributor Volume Deal Q1 (PRO-035)	Volume	Laundry	Distributor	20 Jan - 02 Mar 2026	14%	200
Spring Clean Blitz (PRO-026)	TPR	Surface Cleaners	Modern Trade	03 Mar - 23 Mar 2026	12%	50
Spring Clean Blitz (PRO-027)	TPR	Surface Cleaners	Traditional Trade	03 Mar - 23 Mar 2026	12%	50
Spring Clean Blitz (PRO-028)	TPR	Dishwashing	Modern Trade	03 Mar - 23 Mar 2026	10%	30
Spring Clean Blitz (PRO-029)	TPR	Dishwashing	Traditional Trade	03 Mar - 23 Mar 2026	10%	30

Promotion	Type	Category	Channel	Dates	Discount	Minimum volume (units)
Traditional Trade Support (PRO-036)	Feature	Dishwashing	Traditional Trade	07 Apr - 27 Apr 2026	9%	20
Modern Trade Exclusive (PRO-037)	Display	Laundry	Modern Trade	12 May - 25 May 2026	7%	60
Summer Refresh (PRO-030)	Feature	Dishwashing	Modern Trade	02 Jun - 15 Jun 2026	8%	40
Summer Refresh (PRO-031)	Feature	Surface Cleaners	Modern Trade	02 Jun - 15 Jun 2026	8%	40

The second-half 2026 calendar (Back to School, Fall Cleaning Event, Holiday Bundle, Distributor Volume Deal Q3, Traditional Trade Support for Laundry) has not been published yet.

4 Preparing a store for a promotion

1. **Order early.** Stock-outs are more frequent on promotion days *(data)*: Modern Trade 8.3% vs 6.3% on other days, Traditional Trade 10.4% vs 8.6%, Distributors 10.1% vs 7.7%. Place the order so it arrives before the start date: delivery takes a median of 2 days for Distributors, 3 for Modern Trade and 5 for Traditional Trade.
2. **Secure the space.** For Display and Feature promotions, agree the display location and the price communication with the store.
3. **Check MSL first.** A promotion on a category does not help if an MSL SKU in that category is out of stock.
4. **Watch the end.** After a deep promotion, the store may hold extra stock; adjust the next order instead of pushing more volume.

5 Promotions and trade discounts are different

- A **consumer promotion** lowers the price shoppers pay for a planned period. It appears in the calendar above.
- A **trade discount** lowers the price the account pays Marvel on an invoice. Its limits are the guardrails in MCPG-05.

Never add the two together into one discount, and never present a promotion as a substitute for a guardrail approval.

6 Minimum volume

Each promotion has a min_volume_units value (20 to 200 units). Distributor Volume Deals require at least 200 units. Whether the minimum applies per invoice line, per order or over the whole promotion period has not been confirmed. In the data, only about a third of promoted invoice lines reach the minimum on their own.

Document control

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Open points and review notes

- Promotion type descriptions are general definitions written for this knowledge base; the dataset only records the type name, discount and minimum volume.
- Elasticities come from temporary price cuts. They are not a direct estimate of how shoppers respond to a permanent price increase.